

Age-cohort regressions with ESS-MPD matched data

ESS-MPD project

April 2026

Regressions

Raw composite indices (TR sample + top-up)

$$\underbrace{MPD_{it}}_{\text{Composite index}} = \alpha + \underbrace{\sum_k \beta_k \mathbf{1}\{Age_{it} \in Cat_k\}}_{\text{Age category dummies (omitting 18-34)}} + \underbrace{\mathbf{x}'_{it}\Theta}_{\text{Vector of controls}} + \underbrace{\gamma_{ct}}_{\text{Country} \times \text{election year FEs}} + \underbrace{\eta_g}_{\text{Generation FEs}} + \varepsilon_{it}$$

	Economic index			Cultural index		
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
35-49	-0.012 (0.013)	0.001 (0.013)	0.005 (0.007)	0.026** (0.010)	0.014 (0.012)	0.028 (0.019)
50-64	-0.010 (0.030)	-0.007 (0.029)	-0.009 (0.012)	0.033* (0.017)	0.008 (0.020)	0.036 (0.027)
65+	-0.068 (0.042)	-0.089** (0.043)	-0.061* (0.031)	0.063* (0.031)	0.025 (0.038)	0.043 (0.039)
Baby Boomers (1946-1964)			0.053** (0.025)			-0.022 (0.014)
Generation X (1965-1980)			0.024* (0.013)			0.011 (0.017)
Millennials and Gen Z (post-1981)			0.050** (0.021)			0.013 (0.027)
R-squared	0.351	0.356	0.356	0.263	0.272	0.272
Observations	256947	255219	255219	256947	255219	255219
Country × election year FEs	×	×	×	×	×	×
Generational cohort FEs			×			×
Controls		×	×		×	×
Mean of outcome	1.803	1.803	1.803	-0.056	-0.056	-0.056
SD of outcome	0.961	0.960	0.960	0.863	0.863	0.863

Notes: TR sample + top-up. Standard errors clustered at the country level in parentheses. Economic index: higher = more left-wing. Cultural index: higher = more traditional/sovereignty. Significance levels: * $p < .1$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$.

Standardized composite indices, z-scored (TR sample + top-up)

$$\underbrace{MPD_{it}^z}_{\text{z-scored index}} = \alpha + \underbrace{\sum_k \beta_k \mathbf{1}\{Age_{it} \in Cat_k\}}_{\text{Age category dummies (omitting 18-34)}} + \underbrace{\mathbf{x}_{it}'\Theta}_{\text{Vector of controls}} + \underbrace{\gamma_{ct}}_{\text{Country} \times \text{election year FEs}} + \underbrace{\eta_g}_{\text{Generation FEs}} + \varepsilon_{it}$$

	Economic index			Cultural index		
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
35-49	-0.014 (0.015)	0.001 (0.015)	0.005 (0.008)	0.032** (0.012)	0.017 (0.014)	0.034 (0.023)
50-64	-0.012 (0.035)	-0.008 (0.034)	-0.011 (0.014)	0.040* (0.020)	0.009 (0.024)	0.043 (0.032)
65+	-0.078 (0.048)	-0.102** (0.050)	-0.070* (0.035)	0.076* (0.038)	0.030 (0.045)	0.051 (0.047)
Baby Boomers (1946-1964)			0.061** (0.029)			-0.026 (0.017)
Generation X (1965-1980)			0.028* (0.015)			0.013 (0.020)
Millennials and Gen Z (post-1981)			0.057** (0.024)			0.016 (0.032)
R-squared	0.351	0.356	0.356	0.263	0.272	0.272
Observations	256947	255219	255219	256947	255219	255219
Country × election year FEs	×	×	×	×	×	×
Generational cohort FEs			×			×
Controls		×	×		×	×
Mean of outcome	0.044	0.044	0.044	-0.033	-0.033	-0.033
SD of outcome	1.102	1.101	1.101	1.037	1.037	1.037

Notes: TR sample + top-up. Standard errors clustered at the country level in parentheses. Both indices z-scored across all observations. Significance levels: * $p < .1$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$.

PCA composite indices, PC1 (TR sample + top-up)

$$\underbrace{MPD_{it}^{PC1}}_{\text{PCA index}} = \alpha + \underbrace{\sum_k \beta_k \mathbf{1}\{Age_{it} \in \text{Cat}_k\}}_{\text{Age category dummies (omitting 18-34)}} + \underbrace{\mathbf{x}'_{it}\Theta}_{\text{Vector of controls}} + \underbrace{\gamma_{ct}}_{\text{Country} \times \text{election year FEs}} + \underbrace{\eta_g}_{\text{Generation FEs}} + \varepsilon_{it}$$

	Economic index			Cultural index		
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
35-49	-0.027 (0.029)	-0.007 (0.029)	0.005 (0.014)	0.035** (0.016)	0.017 (0.019)	0.047 (0.029)
50-64	-0.020 (0.063)	-0.020 (0.058)	-0.021 (0.024)	0.041 (0.028)	-0.000 (0.035)	0.057 (0.040)
65+	-0.128 (0.090)	-0.173* (0.087)	-0.126** (0.057)	0.074 (0.052)	0.011 (0.064)	0.057 (0.063)
Baby Boomers (1946-1964)			0.086** (0.041)			-0.028 (0.022)
Generation X (1965-1980)			0.028 (0.022)			0.028 (0.031)
Millennials and Gen Z (post-1981)			0.089** (0.043)			0.045 (0.042)
R-squared	0.272	0.276	0.277	0.228	0.237	0.237
Observations	256947	255219	255219	256947	255219	255219
Country × election year FEs	×	×	×	×	×	×
Generational cohort FEs			×			×
Controls		×	×		×	×
Mean of outcome	-0.012	-0.012	-0.012	-0.054	-0.053	-0.053
SD of outcome	1.534	1.534	1.534	1.377	1.378	1.378

Notes: TR sample + top-up. Standard errors clustered at the country level in parentheses. PC1 within each bundle, sign-aligned with raw index. Significance levels: * $p < .1$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$.

Polarization

Polarization over time: economic vs. cultural dimension

